

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO
UNIFIED FAMILY COURT

JACQUELINE MARGUERITE R B PALLAS,

Petitioner

VS.

DERRICK LYNDON PALLAS,

Respondent

) Case Number: FDI-22-797295

) Hearing Date: August 11, 2026

) Hearing Time: 9:00 AM

) Department: 404

) Presiding: AI MORI

OTHER REVIEW HEARING

TENTATIVE RULING

Having read and considered the pleadings, declarations, and other evidence submitted in this matter, the Court makes the following findings and orders:

A. Procedural History

- 1) The parties in this matter are Petitioner Jacqueline Pallas (Mother) and Respondent Derrick Pallas (Father). The parties married on 2/19/2011. The parties disagree as to their exact date of separation but agree they were married for at least 11 years and 9 months. The parties have two minor children, Samuel (DOB: 3/11/2014, age 12) and Joseph (DOB: 9/18/2021, age 4). Mother is represented by attorney Michelle Harris. Father is represented by attorney Gary Dubrovsky.
- 2) On 11/7/2025, Mother filed a Request for Order asking the Court to order Father to return to the workforce and seek work commensurate with his earning ability and historical income.
- 3) On 2/18/2026, a Stipulation and Order was filed which appoints Soma McCandless as an Evidence Code section 730 vocational evaluator to perform a vocational evaluation of Father.
- 4) At the prior 3/12/2026 hearing, the Court set a future hearing date of 6/25/2026 to “determine whether a Seek Work order remains necessary and, if so, the appropriate scope and parameters.”
- 5) On 6/9/2026, a Stipulation and Order was filed wherein the parties agreed to continue the 6/25/2026 hearing date to 8/11/2026.

- 1 6) On 8/3/2026, Father's attorney filed a Declaration stating that Ms. McCandless is aiming to
2 deliver her report by the end of September "at the latest." Father's attorney asks the Court to
3 continue the 8/11/2026 hearing no earlier than 10/22/2026 so that the parties can review Ms.
4 McCandless' report and submit appropriate briefing.
- 5 7) On 8/4/2026, Mother filed an Update Declaration. Mother agrees that Ms. McCandless has stated
6 that she will not complete her report until the end of September "at the latest." Mother states that
7 the Court should not delay ordering Father to seek work pending completion of Ms. McCandless'
8 report. Mother also states that Father has not been fully cooperative with Ms. McCandless (but
9 she does not provide details regarding this claim) and asks the Court to reserve jurisdiction over
10 sanctions.
- 11 8) On 8/5/2026, Father's attorney filed a Supplemental Declaration wherein he refutes Mother's
12 claim that he has not been fully cooperative with Ms. McCandless. Father's attorney attaches an
13 email from Ms. McCandless' business manager who states: "Mr. Pallas has been cooperative
14 throughout the evaluation process. He has completed all tasks we have requested within the
15 timeframes we provided." Father asks the Court to deny Mother's request for a reservation of
16 jurisdiction on sanctions.

17 **B. Findings and Order**

- 18 1) The Court hereby continues the 8/11/2026 hearing to **Thursday, 11/12/2026 at 9:00 AM in**
19 **Dept. 404.**
- 20 2) At least 20 calendar days prior to the next hearing date, Mother shall file and serve a declaration
21 (not to exceed 5 pages in length, not including exhibits) outlining her position regarding these
22 issues. Mother shall attach to her declaration the vocational evaluation of Ms. McCandless.
- 23 3) At least 10 calendar days prior to the next hearing date, Father shall file and serve a declaration
24 (not to exceed 5 pages in length, not including exhibits) outlining his position regarding these
25 issues.
- 26 4) Father's attorney shall prepare the Findings and Order After Hearing.
- 27 5) **Preparation of Order:** If you are directed by the court to prepare the order after hearing – within
28 10 calendar days of the hearing you must either: (a) Serve the proposed order to the other
29 party/counsel for approval, and follow the procedures set forth in CA Rules of Court, Rule

1 5.125(c), or (b) If the other party did not appear or the matter was uncontested, submit the
2 proposed order after hearing directly to the court. Failure to submit the order after hearing within
3 10 days may allow the other party to prepare a proposed order and submit it to the court in
4 accordance with CA Rules of Court, Rule 5.125(d).
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